

Data Retention & Deletion Schedule

*How long each category of data is kept, and what happens at the end of
an engagement.*

Retention by data category

CATEGORY	RETENTION	BASIS
Account & identity (name, email, year group, DOB/age)	Active account + 24 months from last login, then anonymised	Contract; dormancy purge
Essay submissions & marking feedback	Active enrolment + 24 months; per-essay delete from the dashboard at any time	Contract; service delivery
Parental consent records (consent ledger)	Lifetime of the child account + 7 years (evidentiary), then deletion	Legal obligation; safeguarding evidence
Payment & billing records	7 years from transaction	Legal obligation (tax)
Technical / usage data	12 months from collection	Legitimate interest; minimised
AI interaction data (our side)	Stored alongside the essay for the essay's retention period; anonymised thereafter	Service delivery
Error-monitoring data (Sentry)	90 days	Legitimate interest (debugging)
Transactional email metadata	~45 days at the provider; body not retained beyond delivery	Service delivery
Data-subject-rights request files	3 years from closure	Legal obligation (accountability)
Communication records (support)	3 years from last interaction	Legitimate interest

AI SUB-PROCESSOR SIDE

Essay text sent to the AI sub-processor carries no directly identifying fields. Our contractual position is zero retention and no training on submissions; the written confirmation is being finalised with counsel (see Document 03). When closed, this row will state the confirmed AI-side retention explicitly.

Deletion on request

- A student or parent can delete the account in one click from the privacy dashboard.
- Deletion removes personal data within **30 days**, with backup eviction completing within **90 days**.
- For children's accounts, deletion includes consent-ledger entries beyond the evidentiary minimum, on guardian request.

End of a school engagement – the exit pack

On termination or expiry of a pilot or annual deployment, at the school's choice we will either return or delete the school's student personal data. On request, we provide a **48-hour exit pack**:

- A full export of the school's student data in a structured, machine-readable format.
- Written confirmation of deletion once the school confirms it has its export.
- An audit certificate recording what was deleted and when.

Backups

Operational backups are retained on a rolling short window for disaster recovery and are evicted on the 90-day cycle above. Backups are encrypted at rest and are not used for any purpose other than recovery.